

FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING CD23731
REPORT

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this report titled "Film Making and Radio Podcasting CD23731" is the bonafide work of ASHWINTH AG(231701006) who carried out the work under my supervision. Certified further that to the best of my knowledge the work reported herein does not form part of any other thesis or dissertation on the basis of which a degree or award was conferred on an earlier occasion on this or any other candidate.

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

CHAPTER NO.	TITLE	PAGE NO.
1.	INTRODUCTION	1
2.	PROJECT OVERVIEW	2
3.	TITLE – RANSOM	3
4.	GENRE	4
5.	OBJECTIVES	5
6.	STORY DEVELOPMENT	6
7.	STORY SYNOPSIS.....	7
8.	CHARACTERS	8
9.	SCENE DEVELOPMENT	9
10.	CLIMAX AND ENDING.....	11
11.	CINEMATOGRAPHY	12
12.	LIGHTING	13
13.	SOUND DESIGN	14
14.	EDITING TECHNIQUES	15
15.	USE OF PROPS AND LOCATION.....	16
16.	RADIO PODCAST ADAPTATION	17
17.	RADIO PODCAST SCRIPT APPROACH.....	18
18.	VOICE AND AUDIO PERFORMANCE	19
19.	PRODUCTION PROCESS	20
20.	CHALLENGES FACED	21
21.	LEARNING OUTCOMES	22
22.	EXPECTED OUTCOME	23
23.	CONCLUSION.....	24

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Film making is a creative form of visual communication that combines storytelling, acting, cinematography, sound, lighting and editing to communicate an idea or experience to an audience. A short film presents a complete story within a limited duration, making it important to develop a clear concept and use every scene effectively. Radio podcasting, on the other hand, communicates stories through audio elements such as narration, dialogue, music, sound effects and silence. Both forms require creativity, planning and effective storytelling.

The project titled “RANSOM” is a short crime-thriller film developed as part of the Film Making and Radio Podcasting course. The story begins with an ordinary act of financial desperation: a man named K1 is behind on his loan repayments and, on impulse, decides that kidnapping a child for ransom is his only way out. He abducts a young boy walking home from school and hides him in an isolated safehouse.

The story develops as K1 brings two associates, K2 and K3, into the plan. K2 reacts with fear and disbelief, while K3 pushes them to see the plan through. A ransom call is placed to the boy's father, who is left shaken but quickly channels his fear into determined action, using a number-tracking app to locate the caller. The film ends with the father fighting his way through the kidnappers to rescue his son, closing with a tense reunion rather than a conventional resolution of the crime.

The project is designed not only as a visual short film but also as a story that can be adapted into a radio podcast. The visual elements of the film, particularly its action and confrontation, can be replaced by narration, voice acting, sound effects and background music in the podcast version.

CHAPTER 2

PROJECT OVERVIEW

The main idea of RANSOM is to show how ordinary desperation can escalate into a serious crime, and how that crime sets off consequences the perpetrators did not fully anticipate. The opening scene intentionally grounds the audience in a believable, everyday problem — an overdue loan repayment — before the story turns towards crime. This realistic starting point helps the audience understand, even if they do not sympathise with, K1's decision.

Once the boy is taken, the film shifts between three spaces: the safehouse where the boy is held, K2's house where the plan is debated, and the father's house where fear turns into resolve. Cross-cutting between the ransom call and the father's reaction builds tension without requiring elaborate production resources. The final act compresses into a single, continuous location — the safehouse — where the confrontation and rescue play out in an unbroken rise of intensity.

The film uses a small number of locations, a five-character cast and easily available props such as phones, a motorbike and a car. This keeps the project practical to produce while still allowing camera work, sound design, parallel editing and physical performance to be demonstrated.

CHAPTER 3

TITLE – RANSOM

The title “RANSOM” refers most directly to the money K1 demands from the boy's father in exchange for his son's safe return. This is the literal engine of the plot: a debt K1 cannot pay pushes him toward extracting a different kind of payment from someone else.

The title also carries a second, more personal meaning. Over the course of the film, each character pays a price that has nothing to do with money: K1 forfeits his freedom and self-image, K2 pays in guilt and fear, and the father pays in the terror of almost losing his son. The word “ransom” therefore functions on two levels — as the literal demand driving the plot, and as a way of describing what every character ultimately gives up or risks.

CHAPTER 4

GENRE

The film belongs to the crime-thriller genre, with elements of action in its closing scenes. The thriller quality comes from watching an ordinary man cross a line he cannot uncross, and from the mounting pressure of a plan involving three people who do not fully trust one another. The action element enters later, through the father's physical pursuit and confrontation at the safehouse.

Suspense is maintained by withholding certainty about how the situation will end: whether K1's associates will hold together, whether the father will find his son in time, and how far the confrontation will go. The audience receives new information at roughly the same pace as the characters, which sustains tension through to the final scene.

The major suspense and tension elements used in the film are:

- An overdue loan notification that establishes motive
- A silent, deliberate abduction in broad daylight
- Disagreement and uneasy agreement among the kidnappers
- A disguised, threatening voice on the ransom call
- A location-tracking app that turns fear into pursuit
- A confrontation and physical struggle at the safehouse
- A tense standoff at the safehouse door
- An escalating final fight before the rescue is complete

CHAPTER 5

OBJECTIVES

The main objective of the project is to create an engaging short crime-thriller using basic film-making techniques and a modest production setup. The project also aims to demonstrate how camera work, lighting, editing, sound and physical performance can be combined to build tension and convey escalating stakes.

The specific objectives are:

- To develop an original short-film story built around a moral turning point.
- To understand screenplay and scene development across multiple locations.
- To practise camera framing for both dialogue-driven and action-driven scenes.
- To use lighting to distinguish tone between locations.
- To use parallel editing (cross-cutting) to build suspense during the ransom call.
- To choreograph and shoot a physical confrontation safely and convincingly.
- To understand the importance of background music and sound effects in tension-building.
- To adapt the story into a radio podcast format.
- To understand how physical action can be communicated through sound alone.

CHAPTER 6

STORY DEVELOPMENT

The story was developed around a single question: what happens when an ordinary person, under real financial pressure, makes one impulsive and irreversible decision? Keeping the trigger simple — an overdue loan notice — allowed the escalation that follows to feel earned rather than arbitrary.

The first part establishes K1's desperation and the opportunity that presents itself. The abduction itself was kept quick and largely wordless, relying on physical staging rather than dialogue to create discomfort. Bringing K2 and K3 into the plan afterward allowed the story to explore differing reactions to the same crime — fear, resignation and hardened resolve — within a single scene.

The middle section was built around the ransom call, intercut with the father's reaction, so that both sides of the conversation carry equal weight. The final section was developed to escalate step by step: first a physical confrontation with K1, then with K2, then the reunion with the son, and finally the most difficult obstacle — K3 — saved for last so that the intensity peaks just before the story resolves.

CHAPTER 7

STORY SYNOPSIS

K1, a man in his thirties, sits astride his parked motorbike scrolling through his phone. A loan app notification warns him that his EMI payment is overdue for the final time. Muttering to himself about where he is supposed to find that kind of money, he looks up and notices a young boy walking alone, absorbed in his phone. K1's expression shifts from worry to calculation.

He follows the boy at a distance, closes the gap without a sound, and pulls a cloth bag over the boy's head. The boy struggles briefly before going limp. K1 takes the boy's phone and carries him away.

K1 brings the boy to a rundown shed off a dirt track and lowers him against the wall, checking that he is still breathing. For a moment, doubt crosses K1's face — but he turns, leaves, and bolts the door from outside.

At K2's house, K1 tells K2 and K3 what he has done. K2 is horrified and accuses K1 of losing his mind. K3 steps between them, arguing that shouting will not undo what has already happened, and that what matters now is what they do next. K2 reluctantly agrees: what's done is done. The three settle into an uneasy alliance.

Using the boy's phone, K1 calls the father. The father answers expecting to hear his son's voice and instead hears a disguised voice tell him that his son is being held and will be returned only after payment. Shaken, the father agrees to pay and is warned not to involve the police.

After the call, the father's fear hardens into resolve. He opens a number-tracking app, enters the caller's digits, and watches a location pin drop onto a map showing an industrial lot on the edge of town. He grabs his car keys and leaves immediately.

The father's car skids to a stop outside the shed. He confronts K1 first, striking him down before he can react, then drags him inside by the collar. K2 tries to flee through a side exit but is caught within steps. A short, brutal struggle leaves both K1 and K2 beaten and cornered.

Pushing further into the shed, the father finds his son curled against the far wall — frightened but unhurt. He drops to his knees and pulls the boy into his arms, holding him and promising that he will not let go again.

As the father guides his son toward the door, K3 blocks the way. The father pushes his son behind him and tells him to run. What follows is a fast, ugly fight between the two men, until K3 finally goes down and stays down. The father turns without a word and walks out to where his son is waiting.

CHAPTER 8

CHARACTERS

K1 is the film's central figure — a man whose financial desperation drives the entire plot. He is not written as a purely villainous character; his hesitation after leaving the boy in the safehouse, and the flicker of doubt on his face, suggest a man aware of the line he has crossed. His arc moves from anxious calculation to guilt to, ultimately, consequence.

K2 functions as the story's conscience. His shock and anger at K1's actions give the audience a way to register how extreme the crime is, even as he ultimately goes along with it. His reluctant complicity makes him a more sympathetic, if still culpable, figure than K1 or K3.

K3 is the hardest of the three kidnappers, the one who argues for pressing ahead and who, fittingly, is the last and most difficult obstacle the father must overcome. He is given the least hesitation of the group, which sets him apart from K1 and K2.

The son is eight years old, first seen absorbed in his phone on the walk home — an ordinary detail that makes his abduction more unsettling. For most of the middle section he is unseen, existing only as the reason for the father's fear, until his reappearance in the safehouse gives the story its emotional turning point.

The father begins the story as a man defined by fear — gripping the phone, staring at his son's empty shoes by the door. That fear curdles into focus and, ultimately, force. His transformation from a frightened parent into someone capable of fighting through three men is the emotional core of the film's second half.

CHAPTER 9

SCENE DEVELOPMENT

9.1 Scene 1 – The Street

The film opens on K1 astride his parked motorbike, scrolling through a loan app notification. Wide and medium shots establish the street and K1's restlessness. A close-up on the phone screen reveals the overdue-EMI warning, giving the audience his motive before a single word of dialogue is needed.

When K1 notices the boy across the street, the camera can follow his eyeline in a slow pan, letting the audience arrive at his intentions just before he acts. The abduction itself should be shot quickly and with minimal cutting, relying on staging and sound rather than dialogue to create discomfort.

9.2 Scene 2 – The Safehouse

K1 arrives on foot at an isolated shed, the boy over his shoulder. Wide establishing shots of the rundown structure and its dirt-track approach emphasise isolation. Inside, a close shot on K1 checking that the boy is still breathing, followed by a held beat on his face as doubt appears, gives the audience a brief window into his conscience before he bolts the door and leaves.

9.3 Scene 3 – K2's House

This scene is dialogue-driven and can be shot mostly in medium and close shots within the cramped, cluttered room. K2's rising panic and K3's controlled intervention should be blocked so that K3 physically comes between K1 and K2, visually establishing him as the one holding the plan together. The scene ends on a wide shot of all three standing in uneasy stillness.

9.4 Scene 4 – The Ransom Call

This scene intercuts between the safehouse, where K1 dials with a disguised voice, and the father's house, where he answers expecting his son. Cross-cutting between the two locations — tightening the cuts as the call progresses — builds tension without requiring the characters to be in the same space. A close-up on the father's hand gripping the phone, and on the son's empty shoes by the door, communicates his fear without dialogue.

9.5 Scene 5 – The Tracking

The father's fear turns to resolve as he opens a number-tracking app. Close-up shots of the screen as digits are entered and a location pin drops onto the map let the audience follow his plan in real time. A brief shot of him grabbing his keys and walking out, without hesitation, marks the tonal turn from victim to pursuer.

9.6 Scene 6 – Arrival at the Safehouse

The father's car skids to a stop outside the shed. Handheld camera work here can convey urgency as he scans the lot and spots K1. The confrontation — a single decisive strike — should be shot in short, sharp cuts rather than a drawn-out sequence, establishing the father's determination immediately.

9.7 Scene 7 – Inside the Safehouse

Dragging K1 inside, the father confronts K2, who attempts to flee and is caught within steps. This brief, physical exchange can be shot with tighter framing than the fight in Scene 9, since its purpose is to clear an obstacle rather than build to a climax.

9.8 Scene 8 – The Reunion

The father finds his son curled against the far wall. This is the emotional centre of the film and benefits from a slower pace than the scenes around it — a held two-shot as he kneels and pulls his son into his arms, allowing both performances room to land before the story moves back into urgency.

9.9 Scene 9 – The Final Fight

K3 blocks the door as the father pushes his son behind him and tells him to run. The fight should feel effortful and uneven rather than polished — “no clean shots,” as the script specifies — to reflect that the father is fighting on pure resolve rather than skill. The scene ends on a wide, still shot of the father standing over K3, then walking out to where his son waits.

CHAPTER 10

CLIMAX AND ENDING

The climax occurs across the final safehouse sequence, rising from the father's first strike against K1 through the confrontation with K2, the reunion with his son, and finally the sustained fight with K3. Structuring the climax as a sequence of escalating obstacles, rather than a single confrontation, allows the tension to build continuously rather than peaking and resetting.

The ending resolves the immediate danger — the son is safe and the father has prevailed — but it is deliberately unsentimental. The father walks out “without a word,” and the film does not show any aftermath: no police, no explanation, no consequence shown for K1 and K2 beyond being left beaten on the floor. This restraint keeps the focus on the father and son and leaves the audience to consider what happens next.

CHAPTER 11

CINEMATOGRAPHY

Cinematography is used to mark the shift from an ordinary world into a crisis. The street scene can use naturalistic, slightly loose framing, while the abduction tightens into closer shots to create discomfort. The safehouse scenes benefit from static, controlled framing that emphasises confinement and isolation.

The intercut ransom-call scene should alternate consistent camera language for each location — for instance, handheld for the safehouse and locked-off for the father's house — so that the audience can orient themselves quickly during the cross-cutting. The final fight sequence calls for closer, more mobile camera work, with occasional wider shots to let the physical geography of the struggle read clearly.

CHAPTER 12

LIGHTING

The opening street scene can use natural daylight to establish an ordinary, unremarkable world. The safehouse interior should be lit sparingly — a single shuttered window suggests hard, directional light with heavy shadow, reinforcing the boy's isolation and, later, the tension of the confrontation.

K2's house can use warm, slightly low practical lighting to suit its cluttered, lived-in feel, while the father's house should feel brighter and more composed before the call, then progressively colder in tone as his fear sets in. During the final fight, harder contrast and deeper shadow can heighten the physical intensity of the scene.

CHAPTER 13

SOUND DESIGN

Sound carries much of the film's tension, particularly in scenes where the visual information alone would not convey urgency. The opening scene relies on the notification sound of the loan app and ambient street noise to establish mood before any dialogue. The abduction should be largely wordless, relying on muffled struggle sounds and sudden silence.

Important sound elements include:

- Loan app notification tone
- Street ambience and motorbike engine
- Muffled struggle and breathing sounds
- Phone ringtone and vibration
- Disguised, distorted voice on the ransom call
- Number-tracking app interface sound
- Car engine and tyres during the drive to the safehouse
- Impact sounds during the confrontations and fights
- Sudden silence before and after the reunion

CHAPTER 14

EDITING TECHNIQUES

Editing is central to two very different parts of RANSOM. The ransom-call scene depends on parallel editing (cross-cutting) between the safehouse and the father's house, with cuts tightening in pace as the call reaches its most tense line. This technique lets two simultaneous events build a single rising tension.

The fight sequences, by contrast, call for editing that favours clarity and impact over speed — short, purposeful cuts on contact points rather than rapid, disorienting cutting, so the audience can follow the physical stakes of each exchange. A slower cut rhythm during the reunion scene allows that moment to breathe in contrast to the scenes around it.

CHAPTER 15

USE OF PROPS AND LOCATION

The project is designed to be produced using a small number of accessible locations and props. The main locations are a street, an isolated shed, a cluttered house interior and a second house interior.

The major props required are:

- Motorbike
- Mobile phones (for K1, the son and the father)
- Cloth bag
- Car
- Backpack (for the son)
- Loan app and number-tracking app screens (mocked up for close-ups)
- Basic furniture for K2's house and the father's house

The limited number of locations and props keeps the film practical to shoot while still supporting a multi-location, multi-character story.

CHAPTER 16

RADIO PODCAST ADAPTATION

Adapting RANSOM into a podcast is a particular challenge because much of the film depends on physical action — the abduction, the tracking-app sequence and the final fight — that has no direct audio equivalent. Each of these must be rebuilt around narration, foley and voice performance rather than replaced outright.

In the film, the audience sees the loan app notification on screen; in the podcast, a narrator can describe it while a notification tone plays, or K1 can read the warning aloud under his breath. The silent abduction becomes a sequence of footsteps, a struggle, muffled sound and sudden quiet. The tracking-app sequence can be conveyed through the father narrating his own actions under his breath, paired with app interface sounds. The final fight relies entirely on foley — impacts, breathing, grunts and falling bodies — to convey what the visual version shows directly.

CHAPTER 17

RADIO PODCAST SCRIPT APPROACH

The podcast version can open with a narrator setting the street scene, layered with traffic ambience and a notification tone cueing K1's situation. His muttered dialogue can be kept largely as written, since it already carries his motivation in his own voice.

The abduction can be conveyed through a brief narrated line, followed by sound alone — footsteps, a struggle, cloth rustling, then silence — rather than description, letting the sound effects carry the discomfort the visual version achieves through staging.

The K2's-house scene can be performed largely as dialogue, since it is naturally suited to audio. The ransom call benefits from alternating audio perspectives — filtered or slightly distant sound for K1's disguised voice, clear and close for the father — to distinguish the two ends of the call without any visual cross-cutting.

The tracking sequence can use a few lines of narration or muttered self-talk from the father over interface sounds, and the final rescue and fight should lean entirely on foley, breathing and brief exclamations, with a sudden drop to silence just before the father reaches his son — mirroring the visual version's held, quiet reunion beat.

CHAPTER 18

VOICE AND AUDIO PERFORMANCE

Voice acting carries the full emotional weight of the podcast version, since the audience cannot see any character's face. K1's voice should shift from anxious and muttering at the start to disguised and flat during the ransom call, reflecting the effort of concealment.

K2's voice should carry visible panic and disbelief, while K3's stays controlled and firm, marking him as the more hardened of the two. The father's performance has the widest arc: shaken and pleading on the call, hardening into focus during the tracking sequence, and forceful, breathless and fierce during the rescue and reunion. The son's few lines should sound small and frightened, breaking slightly on the word "Dad?" to land the reunion beat.

The following elements are important:

- Clear pronunciation under physical or emotional strain
- Distinct, consistent voices for each of the five characters
- Voice disguise or filtering for the ransom call
- Controlled breathing and effort sounds during the fights
- Appropriate pauses, especially before the reunion
- Effective use of silence at key turning points

CHAPTER 19

PRODUCTION PROCESS

The production of the project can be divided into three stages: pre-production, production and post-production.

During pre-production, the screenplay was finalised and broken down scene by scene. Locations were identified for the street, the safehouse, K2's house and the father's house, and the fight choreography for Scenes 6, 7 and 9 was planned and rehearsed in advance for safety.

During production, scenes were recorded location by location rather than in story order, to minimise setup time. Multiple takes and camera angles were captured for the fight sequences to give sufficient coverage during editing. Screen recordings of the loan app and tracking app were captured separately for use as close-up inserts. Voice recordings for the podcast version were prepared alongside the film shoot.

During post-production, footage was organised and edited according to the screenplay, with particular attention to the pacing of the cross-cut ransom-call scene and the clarity of the fight sequences. Sound effects, foley, background music and app-interface graphics were added, and the final video was exported after review.

CHAPTER 20

CHALLENGES FACED

Staging a kidnapping and a series of physical confrontations convincingly, while keeping every actor safe, was the most significant challenge of the project. Fight choreography required rehearsal and clear communication so that the action would read as effortful and real without any actual risk to performers.

Coordinating four distinct locations within a limited shooting schedule also required careful planning, particularly since the ransom-call scene depends on precise timing between two separately filmed locations. Casting and directing a child actor for the son's role required additional care to keep the experience comfortable and age-appropriate on set.

Achieving convincing audio synchronisation — notification tones, ringtones, impacts and the disguised voice — at exactly the right moments was another recurring challenge, particularly in the cross-cut call scene, where sound is what makes two separate locations feel like one continuous event.

CHAPTER 21

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Through this project, several practical skills can be developed, including screenplay writing for a multi-location crime-thriller, parallel editing technique, safe fight choreography and staging, and directing performances that carry a wide emotional range.

The project also demonstrates how sound and editing rhythm, rather than dialogue alone, can carry tension — particularly in the cross-cut ransom call and the largely wordless abduction and fight sequences. The radio podcast adaptation provides additional experience in using foley and voice performance to replace action that would otherwise be shown visually, reinforcing how differently the same story must be told across mediums.

CHAPTER 22

EXPECTED OUTCOME

The final outcome of the project is a short crime-thriller film titled RANSOM, supported by a radio podcast adaptation of the same story. The film is expected to engage the audience through its escalation from an ordinary financial pressure into a kidnapping, and through the father's transformation from fear into decisive action.

The project demonstrates the practical use of parallel editing, physical staging, sound design and voice performance. The restrained, unresolved ending — offering no aftermath beyond the reunion — is intended to leave the audience considering the human cost of the events rather than a tidy resolution.

CHAPTER 23

CONCLUSION

The RANSOM project demonstrates how an ordinary pressure — financial desperation — can be developed into a tense crime-thriller through effective use of film-making techniques. The story moves from a believable, everyday problem into an escalating crisis involving five characters, three locations and a rescue that tests both editing and physical performance.

The project combines screenplay writing, acting, cinematography, lighting, sound design, parallel editing and fight staging. Each element contributes to the film's rising tension, and the use of a small number of locations and a compact cast demonstrates that an effective short thriller does not require elaborate production resources.

The radio podcast adaptation further demonstrates how a story built around physical action and visual staging must be rebuilt around narration, foley and voice performance when the visual dimension is removed. Overall, RANSOM provides practical experience in both film making and radio podcasting, while demonstrating how desperation, consequence and resolve can be conveyed through picture and sound alike.

“A debt paid in someone else's fear is never really settled.”